

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in commercial contract review, dispute resolution support and compliance work at BCLP, Adobe, Q-Legal and Citizens Advice. Experienced in reviewing and drafting contracts, conducting legal research, managing case files and deadlines, preparing hearing materials, and communicating complex legal issues to clients and stakeholders. Comfortable working across several matters at once under time pressure, including directly supporting senior lawyers in a major international arbitration and managing data-privacy instructions from start to formal advice. Looking for a permanent in-house paralegal role where commercial legal and compliance work are central.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis, legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team ahead of a significant procedural deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Liaised directly with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Supported acceptance of standard contractual terms: reviewed documentation, flagged provisions needing legal input and communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Identified legal and compliance risks arising from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; contract review and drafting; documentary analysis; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters